

Standard Operating Procedure

Narcotic and Psychotropic Drug Handling

«Hospital Name» — Supports MOM.9.b, MOM.9.c, MOM.9.e (narcotics/psychotropics)

SOP No.	[Hospital to define]	Version	1.0
Effective Date	_____	Review Frequency	Annual, or on change
Prepared By	Quality Coordinator Name: _____ Signature: _____		
Approved By	Medical Superintendent Name: _____ Signature: _____		

1. Purpose

This SOP describes how «Hospital Name» prescribes, stores, and accounts for narcotic and psychotropic drugs in line with the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances (NDPS) Act, preventing diversion or abuse.

2. Scope

Applies to every narcotic and psychotropic substance held or administered at the hospital.

3. Responsibility

Designated/Privileged Medical Officer: is the only person who may prescribe these drugs.

Duty Nurse / Pharmacist: maintains secure storage and reconciles the register every shift.

4. Procedure

1. Confirm the prescriber holds the designated or privileged status required to prescribe narcotics or psychotropics.
2. Store these drugs in a double-locked cabinet, separate from general stock, with access limited to authorised staff only.
3. Reconcile the narcotic/psychotropic register against physical stock at every shift change — opening balance, used/administered, wastage, closing balance.
4. Record wastage with a witness signature, on the same form, at the time it occurs — never after the fact from memory.
5. Dispose of expired or unused narcotics/psychotropics per the NDPS destruction protocol, witnessed by a second authorised person and, where required, a drug inspector.

5. Records

Supported by Records 2, 3, and 5 of the MOM.9 Required Records pack.

6. Related Documents

- Policy on Narcotics, Psychotropics, Chemotherapy and Radio-pharmaceuticals (HCO/MOM/POL/09) — MOM.9 policy
- SOP — Chemotherapy and Radiopharmaceutical Handling (MOM.9)

7. Review

Reviewed annually, and immediately after any discrepancy in the narcotic register.

8. References

- Government of India. (1985). Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances Act, 1985 (Central Act No. 61 of 1985), and the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances Rules, 1985 (as amended). https://www.indiacode.nic.in/bitstream/123456789/15315/1/the_narcotic_drugs_and_psychotropic_substances_act_1985.pdf